Different colour combinations

Violet + red

How it feels

Two from one colour. Violet is made from red and blue, so red is its relative. Together they make a rich, warm pair (burgundy, plum). Red warms violet and violet calms red.

When it suits

When you want **passion with depth**, but not shouting.

Specific shades



violet + red
deeply



plum + wine
sensually



lavender + terracotta
softly



bright violet + scarlet
dramatically



grey-violet + brick
earthily

In practice

A plum jumper and red lipstick. A wine wall and a violet cushion.

Watch out

Large areas of both can feel **heavy**.

Violet + orange

How it feels

Sunset. Orange and violet meet in the sky just after sunset, when orange fades and the sky turns violet. Orange lights violet up and violet calms orange.

When it suits

When you want to **light up** a darker whole.

Specific shades



violet + orange
radiantly



plum + pumpkin
richly



lavender + apricot
softly



grey-violet + terracotta
earthily



lilac + peach
gently

In practice

A violet scarf and an orange lamp. A plum wall with an orange accessory.

Watch out

A rich orange on a large area overpowers violet. An **accent** is enough.

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Violet + yellow

How it feels

The counterpart. Yellow stands opposite violet on the colour wheel, and that is why their contrast is the strongest. Gold on an evening sky, saffron on lilac.

When it suits

When you want **one light spot** in the middle of depth.

Specific shades


violet + lemon
strikingly


plum + golden
festively


lavender + buttery
springlike


grey-violet + mustard
earthily


lilac + vanilla
gently

In practice

A yellow accessory in a lavender room. A yellow candle and a violet blanket.

Watch out

When there is too much yellow, it can **disturb**. Add yellow by the tip of the brush.

Violet + green

How it feels

A flower among leaves. Green and violet together look like lilac or lavender in a garden. They were also two of the three colours of the suffragettes.

When it suits

When you want a **natural contrast**.

Specific shades


violet + green
naturally


plum + bottle green
deeply


lavender + sage
airily


grey-violet + olive
earthily


lilac + mint
freshly

In practice

A violet scarf and a green plant. Lavender in green ceramics.

Watch out

Watch the proportion and richness. Two richly contrasting areas can **tug against each other**.

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Violet + blue

How it feels

Relatives. Blue is one of the colours violet is made from. Together they look calm and deep. Blue cools violet and violet softens blue.

When it suits

When you want **calm with transcendence**.

Specific shades



violet + blue
calmly



plum + navy
deeply



lavender + sky blue
airily



bright violet + cobalt
freshly



grey-violet + washed denim
soberly

In practice

Lavender and light blue in a bedroom. A violet scarf and jeans.

Watch out

Both are cooler. Without warmth the whole can feel **cold**.

Violet + indigo

How it feels

Dusk. Indigo is violet's nearest neighbour in the rainbow. Together they recall an evening sky approaching night. Indigo deepens violet.

When it suits

When you want **depth without shouting**.

Specific shades



violet + indigo
at dusk



plum + ultramarine
deeply



lavender + dusk
gently



bright violet + indigo
richly



grey-violet + grey indigo
soberly

In practice

An indigo coat and a violet scarf. A dark blue-violet in a library.

Watch out

Two deep colours side by side easily merge. Add a **light point**.

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Violet + pink

How it feels

A softer face. Pink is a lighter relative of red, and so with violet it makes a gentle, sensual pair. Violet deepens pink, pink softens violet.

When it suits

When you want **tenderness and playfulness**.

Specific shades



violet + pink
playfully



plum + raspberry
sensually



lavender + powder pink
tenderly



lilac + blossom
springlike



grey-violet + dusty rose
dustily

In practice

Lilac and powder pink on cushions. Plum and pink in a piece of jewellery.

Watch out

A whole that is too sugary can feel **cloying**. Add a neutral colour.

Violet + grey

How it feels

Elegant calm. Grey mutes violet and makes it urban. Together they look sober and a little stormy.

When it suits

When you want **elegance** without showiness.

Specific shades



violet + grey
soberly



plum + graphite
elegantly



lavender + silver
lightly



bright violet + slate
modernly



grey-violet + dove grey
quietly

In practice

A grey blazer and a violet scarf. A grey wall and a lavender throw.

Watch out

A cold grey with a cool violet can feel **cold**. Try a warmer material.

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Violet + brown

How it feels

Earth under your feet. Brown grounds violet. Together they look like plums in a wooden bowl or heather in autumn.

When it suits

When you want **violet with earth**.

Specific shades



violet + brown
earthily



plum + chocolate
deeply



lavender + beige
softly



heather + caramel
autumnally



grey-violet + linen
naturally

In practice

A wooden table and a violet cushion. A brown coat and a plum scarf.

Watch out

Two dark colours can merge. Add a **light accent**.

Violet + white

How it feels

A clean sheet. White brightens violet and gives it space. Together they recall lilac in spring and the suffragettes.

When it suits

When you want **purity and light**.

Specific shades



violet + white
cleanly



plum + cream
elegantly



lavender + snow white
freshly



bright violet + white
strikingly



grey-violet + lilac white
gently

In practice

A white kitchen with violet ceramics. A white shirt and a violet scarf.

Watch out

A pair with too much contrast can feel **austere**.

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Violet + black

How it feels

Evening depth. Black and dark violet are very close. An elegant but heavy pair.

When it suits

When you want **evening elegance**.

Specific shades


violet + black
mysteriously


plum + charcoal
deeply


aubergine + graphite
soberly


bright violet + black
dramatically


grey-violet + black
unobtrusively

In practice

A black dress and a violet scarf. A blackboard and a lavender detail.

Watch out

When there is too much, **light** is missing. Add white or gold.

Violet + gold

How it feels

A royal pair. Violet and gold have belonged together since the days of purple and imperial robes. Gold lights violet up and violet gives gold depth.

When it suits

When you want **festivity and prestige**.

Specific shades


violet + gold
festively


plum + antique gold
richly


lavender + champagne
gently


grey-violet + matte gold
subtly


lilac + pale gold
airily

In practice

A gold piece of jewellery on a plum jumper. Violet packaging with gold lettering.

Watch out

In excess gold **drowns out ordinary comfort**. A detail is enough.

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A SIMPLE RULE

- When you want to **soften** violet, add **white**, **cream**, **lavender** or **grey**.
- When you want to **ground** it, add **brown**, **green**, **wood** or **natural materials**.
- When you want to **light it up**, add **yellow**, **orange** or **gold**.
- When you want to **deepen** it, **plum**, **wine** or **black** will help.

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